

a collaborative effort, so between Storyteller and players you'll determine the kind of game you want to play, with the kind of rules you wish to use. The goal is to combine efforts to tell the most amazing story possible.

If your group comes to disagree regarding rules at any point during the game, take a short break and discuss the issue. Ultimately, it's up to the Storyteller to adjudicate appropriately. The Storyteller can make decisions regarding whether the rulings in the book come first, if rules should come down to a vote within the group, or through any other method she chooses. Remember, the game exists for the players to have fun, so travel the path of most enjoyment.

Rolling Dice

Changeling uses 10-sided dice. You can find these in most game stores or via online retailers, or you can use a number of software dice rollers (including quite a few apps for smartphones and online play). The Storyteller will need some dice, as will the players. Both the players and the Storyteller should start with at least 10 dice between them.

Roll dice whenever the outcome of an action is in doubt or the Storyteller thinks there's a chance an action might fail. Conditions such as stress, injury, and the toughness of an opponent affect the difficulty target number. Your character's strengths and weaknesses affect the number of dice rolled, and thus directly affect chances of success. (Both of these concepts are discussed in detail anon.) The dice give a sense of chance or destiny to a situation calling for a roll, and do so objectively

for everyone, so every player has an opportunity to succeed at her character's actions, or fail interestingly.

That last bit is important. The Storyteller should make the call on whether a roll's necessary when there's no potential for failure. Dice rolling can be exciting, but it can also disrupt the pace of a game. Moderating the pace is a key Storyteller technique, so Storytellers shouldn't have players roll dice unless there's a decent reason. Where multiple possible interesting outcomes exist, there's a need for dice rolling. If a game event sees the characters traveling from A to B no matter the content of the journey, it likely doesn't require dice rolling. Roll dice only if roleplaying or the mutual consent of the players doesn't resolve the matter. Use dice to enhance play rather than drive it.

Consider these situations:

The oathcircle follows clues and overcomes trials leading them to the hidden House Balor library, where the answer to riddle of the Thallain is known to be in its most ancient book. This event may at first seem a natural place for a Wits + Investigation, or even an extended Intelligence + Academics roll, but possibly not. A dice roll isn't needed if this is the only place the characters can find the answer to their riddle. If the riddle can't be solved, the story becomes stuck at this point. Rather, this situation can be roleplayed, with a little narrative color to describe the time it takes for the changelings to find their book. Alternatively, the Storyteller could have avoided this situation by having the answer given to them by an interesting character met in the library. If the players do feel inclined to roll dice, reward high successes with additional nuggets of forbidden lore and maybe a treasure or two.

